

Lab Sheet 3: Requirements & LEPSI Constraints

Objectives

By completing today's workshop, you will:

- Perform a **Data Privacy Audit** to satisfy GDPR constraints.
 - Define and enforce a **Definition of Done (DoD)** using GitHub Pull Request Templates.
 - Run the **Virtual Robot Simulation container** and analyze its live API documentation to define interface requirements.
 - Critically analyze your system for **Dual Use** ethical implications.
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Introduction: Requirements in Practice

In this week's lecture, we established that Legal, Ethical, Professional, and Social Issues (LEPSI) are **Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs)** that shape your software architecture. Today, you will translate those theoretical constraints into tangible project artifacts for your Assessment 1 (Robot Management System).

Task 1: GDPR & Data Privacy Audit

Goal: Identify Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and document your data handling policy.

The Concept: The General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) mandates "Privacy by Design." Two key principles are:

- **Data Minimisation:** Only collect the data absolutely necessary to fulfill the system's purpose.
- **Storage Limitation:** Do not keep data longer than needed.

Your Assessment 1 brief requires "Mission Logging (Audit Trail)" which logs every command sent to the robot, including the user who sent it. This means you are processing PII.

Action:

1. In your GitHub repository, create a new file named `PRIVACY_POLICY.md` (or add a page to your GitHub Wiki).
2. Write a short (2-3 paragraph) policy that answers the following:
 - **What PII is collected?** (e.g., Usernames, IP addresses, Timestamps of actions).

- **Why is it collected?** (e.g., To satisfy the safety audit requirement of the Ground Control Station).
 - **How is it secured?** (e.g., Access to the audit log is restricted via Role-Based Access Control to 'Auditor' roles only).
3. Commit and push this file. This serves as evidence of Professional and Legal consideration for your final report.

Task 2: Enforcing the Definition of Done (DoD)

Goal: Automate your project checklist using a GitHub Pull Request Template.

The Concept: A Definition of Done is useless if you forget to check it. In professional software engineering, teams use Pull Request (PR) templates to force developers to tick off the DoD checklist before their code can be merged into the `main` branch.

Action:

1. In the root of your local repository, create a hidden folder named `.github`
2. Inside that folder, create a file named `pull_request_template.md`.
3. Copy and paste the following markdown into the file:

```
## Description
Briefly describe the changes in this PR. Closes #<Issue_Number>

## Definition of Done (DoD) Checklist
Please confirm that this PR meets our quality standards:
- [ ] Code compiles and runs locally without errors.
- [ ] Unit tests for new logic have been written and pass.
- [ ] UI changes have been checked for WCAG Accessibility.
- [ ] No hardcoded passwords or API keys are in the code.
- [ ] AI Verification Log (in Appendix A) has been updated.

## Testing Instructions
How can the reviewer test this feature? (e.g., "Run docker-compose up,
log in as Commander, and click Move").
```

4. Commit and push this file.
5. Now, create a new branch, make a tiny change (e.g., update the README), and open a Pull Request on GitHub. You should automatically see your DoD checklist appear in the description box!

Task 3: Analyzing Live API Interface Requirements

Goal: Run the Virtual Robot Docker container and interact with its live API documentation to define the exact data contract between your frontend dashboard and the robot.

The Concept: An API specification serves as a strict interface requirement. You have been provided with a Docker container that simulates the robot and hosts its own live interactive documentation (Swagger UI). Before building your dashboard, you must run this container and analyze the contract to understand what data formats are strictly required.

Action:

1. Ensure Docker Desktop is running on your machine.
2. Open a terminal (Terminal, PowerShell, or Git Bash) and run the following command to start the simulation:

```
docker run -p 5000:5000 ghcr.io/francescodelduchetto/cmp9134_2526_robotsim:latest
```

3. Once the container is running, open a web browser and navigate to the live API documentation at: <http://localhost:5000/docs>.
4. Analyze the visualized documentation. You should identify specific endpoints such as `/api/status` and `/api/move`.
5. Expand the `POST /api/move` endpoint and inspect the required schema. Try sending a request through the web interface to see how the system responds.
6. **Update your Trello Requirements:** Go to your Trello board and find the User Story related to navigating the robot. Add the exact interface requirements you discovered as **Acceptance Criteria**, for example:
 - *"The dashboard must allow the Commander to input whole numbers for the X and Y coordinates to move the robot."*
 - *"If the Commander enters invalid characters (e.g., letters or decimals) for the coordinates, the system must display a clear error message and prevent the robot from moving, rather than crashing."*

Go back to the lecture slides and review all the different types of (non-functional) requirements you can add as Acceptance Criteria to make your User Stories more robust and testable. Remember that "good" Acceptance Criteria must be:

- **Testable:** There is a clear pass/fail outcome.
- **Clear & Concise:** Easy for non-technical stakeholders to understand.
- **User Perspective:** Focused on the end-user experience, not the backend code.
- **Comprehensive:** Covers both the 'happy path' and negative edge cases.

Task 4: Validating Requirements with an AI Stakeholder Persona

Goal: Refine and validate your Acceptance Criteria by simulating a stakeholder review using an AI tool.

The Concept: In Agile, requirements must be validated by the Product Owner or stakeholders to ensure they accurately reflect business and safety needs. Since you are working solo on Assessment 1, you can use Generative AI (like ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini) to adopt a specific "persona" to critique your User Stories and Acceptance Criteria. This utilizes the "Persona Pattern" in prompt engineering.

Action:

1. Open an AI tool of your choice (we suggest Microsoft Copilot with your university account).
2. Copy the User Story and Acceptance Criteria you updated in Task 3.
3. Use the following **Prompt Template** to personify the AI, and provide the assessment brief and a PDF printout of the Virtual Robot Details for context on the project tasks(from Blackboard: Assessments → Assessment 1 → Virtual Robot Details → print the page to pdf). Fill in the bracketed information with your Task 3 data:

"Act as the [Chief Safety Officer / Non-Technical Operator] for a warehouse deploying a new Virtual Robot Management System. I am the lead software engineer. I am going to provide you with a User Story and its Acceptance Criteria for [Insert your User Story Title].

Please review them from your perspective and tell me:

- 1. Are there any safety, security, or usability edge cases I missed?*
- 2. Is the language clear enough for a non-technical stakeholder to approve?*

Here is the User Story: [Insert your User Story]

Here are the Acceptance Criteria: [Insert your Acceptance Criteria]"

4. Analyze the AI's feedback. Did it suggest adding a confirmation prompt before the robot moves? Did it suggest handling network timeouts?
5. **Refine your Requirements:** Add at least one valid suggestion from the AI to your Trello card's Acceptance Criteria.
6. **CRITICAL STEP:** To comply with Assessment 1 regulations, you **must** log this AI interaction. Open your project's "AI Verification Log" (as required in Appendix A of the brief) and document the prompt you used, the AI's suggestion, and how you validated and applied that suggestion.
7. Feel free to experiment with different personas to get diverse perspectives on your requirements!

Task 4: Dual Use Implications

Goal: Begin drafting the "Social, Ethical, and Entrepreneurial Implications" section of your final report.

The Concept: "Dual Use" technology refers to software or hardware designed for civilian/peaceful purposes that could be misused for malicious or military purposes. You are building a Ground Control Station for an autonomous unit.

Action:

1. Open a document and write a 150-200 word reflection answering the following:
 - What are the worst-case scenarios if an unauthorized actor gains "Commander" access to your Ground Control Station?
 - How does your system design (RBAC, Audit Logging) attempt to mitigate this ethical risk?
2. Save this text. You will use it directly in Section 5 of your Assessment 1 Report.

Further Resources

- **Personas: Why and How You Should Use Them:**
<https://www.interaction-design.org/literature/article/personas-why-and-how-you-should-use-them>
- **Acceptance Criteria: Examples and Best Practices:**
<https://www.atlassian.com/work-management/project-management/acceptance-criteria>
- **ICO Guide to GDPR (UK):**
<https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/uk-gdpr-guidance-and-resources/data-protection-principles/a-guide-to-the-data-protection-principles/>
- **GitHub Docs: Creating a Pull Request Template:**
<https://docs.github.com/en/communities/using-templates-to-encourage-useful-issues-and-pull-requests/creating-a-pull-request-template-for-your-repository>
- **W3C Web Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) Overview:**
<https://www.w3.org/WAI/standards-guidelines/wcag/>